

Claude Code Commands

Command	What it does	Example
<code>claude</code>	Start interactive mode	<code>claude</code>
<code>claude "task"</code>	Start interactive mode with an initial prompt	<code>claude "fix the build error"</code>
<code>claude -p "query"</code>	Run one-off query, then exit	<code>claude -p "explain this function"</code>
<code>claude -c</code>	Continue most recent conversation in current directory	<code>claude -c</code>
<code>claude -r</code>	Resume a previous conversation	<code>claude -r</code>

Session commands

Command	What it does	Example
<code>/clear</code>	Clear conversation history	<code>/clear</code>
<code>/help</code>	Show available commands	<code>/help</code>
<code>/exit</code> or Ctrl+D twice	Exit Claude Code	<code>/exit</code>

Claude Code Commands in VS Code

<https://code.claude.com/docs/en/vs-code>

Command	Shortcut	Description
Focus Input	Cmd+Esc (Mac) / Ctrl+Esc (Windows/Linux)	Toggle focus between editor and Claude
Focus last message	-	Move keyboard focus to the newest message in the conversation, or to a waiting permission prompt, so you can read from there with the keyboard or a screen reader. Not available in terminal mode . Requires Claude Code v2.1.268 or later

Command	Shortcut	Description
Open in Side Bar	-	Open Claude in the sidebar
Open in Terminal	-	Open Claude in terminal mode
Open in New Tab	Cmd+Shift+Esc (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+Esc (Windows/Linux)	Open a new conversation as an editor tab
Open in New Window	-	Open a new conversation in a separate window
New Conversation	Cmd+N (Mac) / Ctrl+N (Windows/Linux)	Start a new conversation. Requires Claude to be focused and <code>enableNewConversationShortcut</code> set to <code>true</code>
Reopen Closed Session	Cmd+Shift+T (Mac) / Ctrl+Shift+T (Windows/Linux)	Reopen the most recently closed Claude session tab. Falls through to VS Code's normal reopen-closed-editor when the last closed tab wasn't a Claude session. Disable with <code>enableReopenClosedSessionShortcut</code>
Insert @-Mention Reference	Option+K (Mac) / Alt+K (Windows/Linux)	Insert a reference to the current file and selection (requires editor to be focused)
Accept Change at Cursor	-	Accept the change at the cursor while reviewing a proposed edit one change at a time. Requires Claude Code v2.1.275 or later
Reject Change at Cursor	-	Revert the change at the cursor while reviewing a proposed edit one change at a time. Requires Claude Code v2.1.275 or later
Toggle Focus view	Ctrl+Option+F (Mac) / Ctrl+Alt+F (Windows/Linux)	Hide or show tool activity in the conversation. Works while a Claude panel or sidebar is visible. Requires Claude Code v2.1.221 or later
Rename Session Tab	-	Rename the session in the active Claude tab. Requires Claude Code v2.1.257 or later
Add Session Tab to Group	-	Add the session in the active Claude tab to a session group you pick or create. Requires Claude Code v2.1.257 or later
Mark Session as Unread	-	Mark the session in the active Claude tab as unread in the sessions list. Requires Claude Code v2.1.257 or later

Command	Shortcut	Description
Show Logs	-	View extension debug logs
Logout	-	Sign out of your Anthropic account

VS Code extension vs. Claude Code CLI

Claude Code is available as both a VS Code extension (graphical panel) and a CLI (command-line interface in the terminal). Some features are only available in the CLI. If you need a CLI-only feature, run `c laude` in VS Code’s integrated terminal. This requires the [standalone CLI install](#): the extension does not add `c laude` to your PATH. See [Run CLI in VS Code](#).

Feature	CLI	VS Code Extension
Commands and skills	All	Subset (type <code>/</code> to see available)
MCP server config	Yes	Yes (add and manage servers with <code>/mcp</code> in the chat panel)
Checkpoints	Yes	Yes
<code>!</code> Bash shortcut	Yes	No
Tab completion	Yes	No

Switch between extension and CLI

The extension and CLI share the same conversation history. To continue an extension conversation in the CLI, run `c laude --resume` in the terminal. This opens an interactive picker where you can search for and select your conversation.

Include terminal output in prompts

Reference terminal output in your prompts using `@terminal:name` where `name` is the terminal’s title. This lets Claude see command output, error messages, or logs without copy-pasting.

Work with git

Claude Code integrates with git to help with version control workflows directly in VS Code. Ask Claude to commit changes, create pull requests, or work across branches. To start Claude in an isolated worktree with its own files and branch, see [Run parallel sessions with worktrees](#).

Create commits and pull requests

Claude can stage changes, write commit messages, and create pull requests based on your work:

```
commit my changes with a descriptive message
```

```
create a pr for this feature
```

```
summarize the changes I've made to the auth module
```

When creating pull requests, Claude generates descriptions based on the actual code changes and can add context about testing or implementation decisions.